Git Branching Strategy & Contribution Policy

Project: Smart Irrigation Alert Dashboard
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1. Branch Naming Conventions

Branch Name	Purpose	Protection Rule
`main`	Production-ready, stable releases (tagged `v1.0`, etc.)	Direct push disabled; merges via PR only
`develop`	Ongoing integration branch for finished features	CI build must pass before merging
`feature/<name>`	Individual feature development (e.g., `feature/sensor-dashboard`)	Created from `develop`, merged back via PR
`bugfix/<name>`	Defect fixes during testing	Merged back into `develop`

2. Commit Message Standard

Follow Conventional Commits format:

- `feat: <description>` — A new feature
- `fix: <description>` — A bug fix
- `docs: <description>` — Documentation only changes
- `ci: <description>` — CI/CD configuration (Jenkinsfile, Dockerfile)
- `test: <description>` — Adding or updating test cases

3. Pull Request (PR) Policy

1. Every feature must have its own branch (`feature/*`).
2. PR must have a meaningful title and description linking to the corresponding GitHub Issue.
3. Code must compile without errors (`mvn compile`).
4. At least one review approval is required before merging into `develop`.